and the *Guardian* newspapers reported on a leak that showed the NSA was working with private technology companies to weaken the encryption used by commercial Internet companies such as Hotmail, Google, Yahoo, and Facebook. In October 2013, the *Guardian* and the *Washington Post* newspapers revealed the NSA and its British counterpart—Government Communications Headquarters (GCHQ)—had jointly planted malicious code into the computers of people using the Tor network. Tor is a free software program used by businesses and individuals that allows them to use the Internet anonymously. The document showed the NSA was attempting to block access to the network and divert users to more unsecured areas of the Internet.

Another story in the *Guardian* in October revealed the NSA had monitored the

MUSCULAR

The PRISM program, which has its guidelines submitted to a FISA court once a year, was allowed to gather data only on foreigners. To get around this legal block, the NSA partnered with the British GCHQ in a program named MUSCULAR. By breaking into worldwide Yahoo and Google fiber-optic links, GCHQ was able to tap into US communications data. Because the United Kingdom—a foreign country—was gathering the data, the communications they transmitted to the United States were now considered "foreign." The NSA could now legally access the data for hundreds of millions of US accounts gathered by GCHQ.[7]

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